



SHEKHAR GHOSH

DELHI | A Mighty Heart

The prime minister stole all the lines during the Sonia Gandhi-Manmohan Singh press conference for the release of the Congress manifesto. It was he who led the assault—whether it was on the BJP, the Third Front, Varun Gandhi or L.K. Advani while Sonia seemed reluctant to attack the Left or her estranged nephew. A resurgent Manmohan kept most of his fire for Advani, who has called him the “weakest prime minister ever”. “What has Advani done except the prominent role he played in the demolition of the Babri Masjid?” asked Manmohan. The dominant message was the sole candidature of Manmohan as the prime ministerial candidate. When asked about Rahul’s plans, Sonia pointed to the manifesto cover, which showed both her and Manmohan. Party sources say there will be no more hoardings of the Manmohan-Sonia-Rahul troika as it has caused too much confusion. Nor was Manmohan apologetic about his plans for not contesting the Lok Sabha elections this time too, saying that “even Indira Gandhi started her career from the Rajya Sabha”. That is one political heart that is beating with a renewed vigour. This is also the first time the Congress has a non-dynasty member as its prime ministerial candidate before the polls.

by Priya Sahgal

MANMOHAN SINGH HAS HIT BACK AT L.K. ADVANI FOR CALLING HIM THE WEAKEST PRIME MINISTER

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is the number of times Manmohan Singh has been a Lok Sabha member, making him the fourth prime minister from the Rajya Sabha.